

Econ 1011 Introduction to Microeconomics

Instructor: **Hyun Soo Suh**
Department of Economics

Summer 2025, Section 21
3.0 Credits

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Office Hours: Wed 11:00AM - 12:00PM

Office: Seigle 378

Course Webpage: [Canvas](#)

Class Hours: Mon-Fri 9:00AM - 10:45AM

Class Room: Seigle 206

Course Description

This summer course will introduce students to the core principles of microeconomics, which studies the behaviors of individuals and firms as they make decisions. We will begin with the foundations — the ten principles of economics, supply, demand, and market equilibrium — and use those tools to study how consumers make choices, how firms operate and compete, and how different market structures function. We will also cover topics in welfare analysis, inequality, and other social issues. Throughout the course, we will focus on building economic intuition through different analytical exercises, applying concepts to real-world examples.

Pre/Co-requisites

There are no required pre-requisites. Participation and effort are all that matter!

Class Expectations

The summer course is an intensive version of a regular semester —15 weeks of material covered in just 5 weeks. Please do not feel overwhelmed, we as a class will work on it together. However, students are expected to come to class, engage, and spend some time *everyday* to digest the class content.

Learning Objectives

By the end of the course, students should be able to:

- Identify and understand the core principles and microeconomic concepts, such as opportunity cost, comparative advantage, and rationality.
- Analyze consumer and producer behavior using tools such as supply and demand, elasticity, and marginal analysis.
- Examine how different market structures (perfect competition, monopoly, oligopoly, and monopolistic competition) influence outcomes related to prices, output, and efficiency.
- Evaluate the impact of market failures, including externalities and public goods, and the role of government intervention.
- Analyze and discuss current economics news using the tools and frameworks learned in class or from the textbook.
- Develop critical thinking skills by solving problems and constructing economic arguments.

Office Hours

Office hours will be held on Wednesdays between 11am and 12pm in my office (Seigle 378). I can also be reached via email, where I respond normally within 24 hours. In case the scheduled office hours do not work for you, please feel free to email me, and we can arrange an alternative time, either in-person or online. I will be available for questions after each class.

Textbook

The main textbook is: *Principles of Microeconomics by N. Gregory Mankiw, 10th edition* (ISBN13: 9780357722862). Students may purchase or rent the copy from the Cengage's website or at the WashU bookstore. Students may also purchase or rent an earlier edition, although the class materials will be based on the 10th. Having the book (or e-book) is mandatory for this course.

In addition to the book, I will provide self-sufficient lecture notes with detailed documents and exercises for students to review the course materials. Lecture notes will be shared before each class.

Grading Policy

The course grade will be a weighted average of homework assignments, one class presentation, one mid-term and one final exam. Details on the weights are described below. I expect the median grade to be above "B" and students' progress will be updated through the Canvas course webpage. For any questions about your grade, please contact me.

1. **Homework Assignments (60 points; 20 points each) - 30%:** Each homework consists of two parts:
 - Multiple-choice questions (12 points): 8 questions + reasoning
 - Short-answer questions (8 points): 2 questions + reasoning

The homework will be posted five days before the deadline and students must submit their own work on Canvas 'Assignment'.

2. **Midterm Exam (100 points) - 25%:** The midterm is in-class and consists of two parts. The first part will be multiple choice questions and the second part consists of short-answer questions, similar to the homework assignments.
3. **Final Exam (100 points) - 25%:** The format is similar to the midterm. The final exam is not cumulative, so it will cover topics after the midterm and specific coverage will be provided on Canvas.
4. **Class Presentation (30 points) - 15%:** In class, we will cover several interesting economics topics. You will choose one theme and give a ten-minute presentation. The assignment includes two components:
 - **Article Selection (5 points):** One week before the presentation, students will be asked to find and submit one or more articles that form the basis of the presentation.
 - **One-on-one meeting (5 points):** Before the presentation, students will schedule individual meetings with me to talk through the structure and goal of the presentation. The sign-up sheet will be posted on Canvas towards the date.
 - **Presentation (20 points):** Students will give a ten-minute presentation based on the chosen topic.

Each presentation will have time for questions and comments of around 5 minutes.

One week before the presentation, I will give a demonstration in class to show what is expected. More detailed guidelines and rubric will be provided on Canvas closer to the presentation date.

5. **Class Participation and Attendance (10 points) - 5%:** Attendance is *strongly* recommended. You will get full credit if you come to 80% of class, 5% if you come to 50%, and none otherwise. Also, please do not be late to class.
Since we have a small student body, class participation is also strongly encouraged. For each chapter, we will go through a few exercises together, so in-class activities will be part of the participation grade.
6. **Extra Credit (5 points) - 2.5%:** Students can get extra credit if they complete the course evaluation before the university deadline. I will give a reminder through Canvas.

Notes

- The homework assignments, presentation, and exams are to be your own work. Any evidence of cheating will be considered a violation of academic integrity and will be reported (please refer to p.7 in the syllabus).
- Students may discuss and work with classmates on homework assignments; however, they need to submitted individually. Identical solutions will be considered a violation of academic integrity.

- I will put strict deadlines on homework assignments. However, exceptions may be granted in case of emergencies, so please let me know by email at least one day prior to the deadline. Students cannot assume to have an exception unless they received a confirmation email from me.
- Students with academic accommodations need to confirm their exam schedules with me by **June 20, 2025**.
- In case of a sudden emergency that would prevent you from taking the midterm exam at the scheduled time, please notify me by email by at least **12am on June 27, 2025**.
- Students cannot assume that they are excused from the exam until they receive a response from me with directions on how to make up the exam. There will be no make-up exams after July 1, 2025.
- For the final exam, please notify me by at least **12 am on July 11, 2025**. There will be no make-up exams after July 15, 2025.
- If students are taking this class with the Pass/Fail option, grades should be at least equivalent to C- to earn the Pass grade.
- Based on the course grades, I will decide if it is necessary to impose a curve.

Grading Scale

Score Range	Letter Grade
Above 97	A+
94 – 97	A
90 – 93	A–
85 – 89	B+
80 – 84	B
75 – 79	B–
70 – 74	C+
65 – 69	C
60 – 64	D+
55 – 59	D
Below 55	F

Important Dates

- **June 9th:** First day of class
- **June 16th:** HW 1 deadline
- **June 23th:** HW 2 deadline
- **June 27th:** Midterm
- **June 30th:** Presentation topic due

- **July 1st:** Presentation meetings
- **July 3rd:** HW 3 deadline
- **July 4th:** No Class
- **July 7th:** Presentation
- **July 11th:** Final exam

Themes

We will cover most topics in Microeconomics including:

- Introduction: Ten principles of Economics (CH 1), thinking like an Economist (CH 2), interdependence and the gains from trade (CH 3)
- How Markets Work: Supply and demand (CH 4), elasticity (CH 5), and government policies (CH 6)
- Markets and Welfare: Consumers, producers, and market efficiency, taxation (CH 7), The costs of Taxation (CH 8), Externalities (Ch 10)
- Firm Behavior and Organization of Industry: Production costs (CH 14), competitive markets (CH 15), monopoly (CH 16), monopolistic competition (CH 17), oligopoly (CH 18)
- If time allows, we will cover:
 - Public goods (CH 11), the health care system (CH 12), tax system (CH 13)
 - Markets for factors of production (CH 19), earnings and discrimination (CH 20)

Tentative Course Schedule

This is a tentative schedule, subject to change. If any changes are made, I will announce them on Canvas, so please make sure you check Canvas before each class.

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
June 9	10	11	12	13
First Class		Office Hours		
CH 1	CH 2	CH 3	CH 4	CH 5
16	17	18	19	20
HW 1 due		Office Hours		
CH 6	CH 7	CH 8	CH 10	CH 14
23	24	25	26	27
HW 2 due		Office Hours	Review	Midterm
CH 14	CH 15	CH 15		
30	Jul 1	2	3	4
Presentation topic due	Presentation Meetings	Office Hours	HW 3 due	NO CLASS
CH 16	CH 16/17	CH 17/18	CH 18	
7	8	9	10	11
Presentation		Office Hours	Review	Final Exam
CH 11	CH 12	CH 19/20		

University-Wide Guidelines & Policies

Reporting Sexual Assault and Harassment: If a student discusses or discloses an instance of sexual assault, sex discrimination, sexual harassment, dating violence, domestic violence or stalking, or if a faculty member otherwise observes or becomes aware of such an allegation, the faculty member will keep the information as private as possible they are required to immediately report it to the Department Chair or Dean or directly to the Gender Equity and Title IX Compliance Office at (314) 935-3393 or titleix@wustl.edu. They will also offer available resources, including confidential support resources through the Relationship and Sexual Violence Prevention (RSVP) at 314-935-3445. Additionally, you can report incidents or complaints to the Office of Student Conduct and Community Standards or by contacting WUPD at (314) 935-5555 or your local law enforcement agency.

Disability Resources (DR): WashU supports the right of all enrolled students to an equitable educational opportunity and strives to create an inclusive learning environment. In the event the physical or online environment results in barriers to the inclusion of a student due to a disability, they should notify the instructor as soon as possible.

Disabled students requiring adjustments to equitably complete expectations in this course should contact WashU's Disability Resources (DR) and engage in a process for determining and communicating reasonable accommodations. Because accommodations are not applied retroactively, DR recommends initiating requests prior to, or at the beginning of, the academic term to avoid delays in accessing accommodations once classes begin. Once established, responsibility for disability-related accommodations and access is shared by Disability Resources, faculty, and the student.

Disability Resources: www.disability.wustl.edu ; 314-935-5970

Statement on Military Service Leave: WashU recognizes that students serving in the U.S. Armed Forces and their family members may encounter situations where military service forces them to withdraw from a course of study, sometimes with little notice. Students may contact the Office of Military and Veteran Services at (314) 935-2609 or veterans@wustl.edu and their academic dean for guidance and assistance.

See: <https://veterans.wustl.edu/policies/policy-for-military-students/>.

Preferred Name and Personal Pronouns: WashU recognizes that many students prefer to use names other than their legal ones to identify themselves. In addition, in order to affirm each person's gender identity and lived experiences, it is important that we ask and check in with others about pronouns. This simple effort can make a profound difference in a person's experience of safety, respect, and support. See: Pronouns Information and Preferred Name.

Emergency Preparedness: Before an emergency, familiarize yourself with the building(s) that you frequent. Know the layout, including exit locations, stairwells and the Emergency Assembly Point (EAP). Review the "Quick Guide for Emergencies" that is found near the door in many classrooms and main lobby areas of buildings for specific emergency information and instructions. For additional Information and EAP maps, visit <https://emergency.wustl.edu/>. To ensure that you receive emergency notifications, make sure your information and cell phone number is updated in SIS, and/or download the WashU Safe app and enable notifications.

To report an emergency:

Danforth Campus: (314) 935-5555

School of Medicine Campus: (314) 362-4357

North/West/South and Off Campus: 911 then (314) 935-5555

Academic Integrity: Effective learning, teaching and research all depend upon the ability of members of the academic community to trust one another and to trust the integrity of work that is submitted for academic credit or conducted in the wider arena of scholarly research. Such an atmosphere of mutual trust fosters the free exchange of ideas and enables all members of the community to achieve their highest potential.

In all academic work, the ideas and contributions of others (including generative artificial intelligence) must be appropriately acknowledged and work that is presented as original must be, in fact, original. Faculty, students and administrative staff all share the responsibility of ensuring the honesty and fairness of the intellectual environment at WashU.

For additional details on the university-wide Undergraduate Academic Integrity policy, please see:

<https://wustl.edu/about/compliance-policies/academic-policies/undergraduate-student-academic-integrity-policy/>

Academic integrity is a serious offense that may lead to warning, probation, suspension, or expulsion from the University. All instances of academic integrity allegations will be reported to Academic Integrity in the Office of the Provost, who will hold an initial meeting and then determine next steps with the student. For more information on the academic integrity policy, procedures, frequently asked questions, and who to contact, visit Academic Integrity in the Office of the Provost. The academic integrity policy, process, and information listed there applies to undergraduate students enrolled in all Schools and programs and master's level students in the McKelvey School of Engineering, the Sam Fox School of Design and Visual Arts, and the School of Continuing and Professional Studies. For all other programs, please see the Contacts page.

Religious Holidays: As home to students, faculty, and staff of all the world's major religions and as a non-sectarian institution, WashU values the rich diversity of spiritual expression and practice found on campus. It is therefore the policy of the university that students who miss class, assignments, or exams to observe a religious holiday should be accommodated. To ensure that accommodations may be made, students who plan to miss class for a religious holiday must inform their instructors in writing before the end of the third week of class, or as soon as possible if the holiday occurs during the first three weeks of the semester. Instructors should inform students on their syllabus and/or at the start of the class how they would like students to notify them of any accommodation needs related to religious observance.

Unauthorized Recording and Distribution of Classroom Activities and Course Materials: Except as otherwise expressly authorized by the instructor or the university, students may not record, stream, reproduce, display, publish or further distribute any classroom activities or course materials. This includes lectures, class discussions, advising meetings, office hours, assessments, problems, answers, presentations, slides, screenshots or other materials presented as part of the course. If a student with a disability wishes to request the use of assistive technology as a reasonable accommodation, the student must first contact the Office of Disability Resources to seek approval. If recording is permitted, unauthorized use or distribution of recordings is also prohibited.

COVID-19 Health and Safety Protocols: Students experiencing symptoms consistent with COVID-19 or concerned about a possible exposure should contact the Student Health Center (314 935-6666) to arrange for testing as indicated. If a student tests positive for Covid-19, they will receive a letter with instructions about any necessary isolation that they can share with their instructors. Any accommodation needs for COVID-related absence not covered in an instructor's standard course

policies should be discussed between the student and instructor.

While on campus, it is imperative that students follow all public health guidelines established to reduce the risk of COVID-19 transmission within our community.

Masking: Masking remains a valuable tool in the mitigation of COVID-19, and all respiratory illnesses. Students and instructors are encouraged to treat requests to mask with care and consideration, keeping in mind that some individuals may be at a higher risk, caring for others at a higher risk, or feeling less comfortable in a mask-optional environment. Based on monitoring of regional and campus conditions, a mask requirement may be implemented as needed.

Students with disabilities for whom masked instructors or classmates create a communication barrier are encouraged to contact Disability Resources (www.disability.wustl.edu) or talk to their instructor for assistance in determining reasonable adjustments. Adjustments may involve amplification devices, captioning, or clear masks but will not allow for the disregard of mask policies should a requirement be in place.

Resources for Students: Confidential Resources for Incidents of Sexual Assault, Sex Discrimination, Sexual Harassment, Dating Violence, Domestic Violence, or Stalking.

WashU is committed to offering reasonable academic supportive measures (e.g. a no-contact order, course changes) to students who are victims of relationship or sexual violence, regardless of whether they seek a formal investigation or criminal charges. If a student needs to explore options for medical care, other services, or reporting, or would like to receive individual counseling services, there are free, confidential support resources and professional counseling services available through the Relationship and Sexual Violence Prevention (RSVP) Center. If you need to request such support, please contact RSVP to schedule an appointment with a confidential and licensed counselor. Although information shared with counselors is confidential, requests for supportive measures will be coordinated with the appropriate University administrators and faculty. The RSVP Center is located in Seigle Hall, Suite 435, and can be reached at rsvpcenter@wustl.edu or (314) 935-3445. For after-hours emergency response services, call the Sexual Assault and Rape Anonymous Helpline (SARAH) at (314) 935-8080 during the academic year, or (314) 935-5555 and ask to speak with an RSVP Center Counselor on call. See: RSVP Center.

Bias Reporting and Support System (BRSS): WashU has a non-punitive process through which students, faculty, staff, and community members who have experienced or witnessed incidents of bias, prejudice, or discrimination against a student can report their experiences to the University's Bias Report and Support System (BRSS) team.

Counseling and Psychological Services: The Center for Counseling and Psychological Services' professional staff members work with students to resolve personal and interpersonal difficulties, many of which can affect a student's academic experience. These include conflicts with or worry about friends or family, concerns about eating or drinking patterns, and feelings of anxiety, depression, and thoughts of suicide. Individual, Conjoint, and Group therapy are all provided in addition to referrals for off-campus support. Information can be found on the CCPS webpage. The Division of Student Affairs also offers a telehealth program to students called TimelyCare. While students are encouraged to visit CCPS during business hours, this additional service also provides after-hours access to medical care and 24/7 access to mental telehealth care across the United States, with no cost at the time of the visit. 12 counseling visits are provided at no charge as well as a limited number of psychiatry appointments. Students who pay the Health and Wellness fee are eligible for this service.

Additionally, see the mental health services offered through the RSVP Center.

WashU Cares: WashU Cares specializes providing referrals and resources, both on, and off campus for mental health, medical health, financial and academic resources by using supportive case management. WashU Cares also receives reports on students who may need help connecting to resources or whom a campus partner is concerned about. If you are concerned about a student or yourself, you can file a report here: <https://carestream.washu.edu>.

The Writing Center: The Writing Center offers free writing support to all WashU undergraduate and graduate students. Staff members will work with students on any kind of writing project, including essays, writing assignments, personal statements, theses, and dissertations. They can help at any stage of the process, including brainstorming, developing and clarifying an argument, organizing evidence, or improving style. Instead of simply editing or proofreading papers, the tutors will ask questions and have a conversation with the writer about their ideas and reasoning, allowing for a higher order revision of the work. They will also spend some time looking at sentence level patterns to teach students to edit their own work.

The Center is located in Mallinckrodt, and appointments are available days and evenings Sunday through Friday. Office staff hours are Monday through Friday 10:00am to 4:00pm. Students are seen primarily by appointment, with walk-ins accepted as the schedule allows. They also have dedicated walk-in hours for undergraduates on Tuesday and Wednesday afternoons. Both in-person and online appointments are available. To make an appointment, go to writingcenter.wustl.edu. Email: writing@wustl.edu.

The Learning Center: The Learning Center provides peer-led support programs, including course-specific mentoring and academic skills coaching (study and test-taking strategies, time management, etc.), that enhance undergraduate students' academic progress.

Contact them at learningcenter@wustl.edu or visit ctl.wustl.edu/learningcenter to find out what support they may offer for your classes.

Center for Diversity and Inclusion (CDI): The Center for Diversity and Inclusion (CDI) supports and advocates for all undergraduate, graduate, and professional school students. We foster belonging for all! Visit our website for more information and resources. The CDI consists of the following offices and is physically located in the Danforth University Center (DUC) Suite 150 and the Women's Building Room 102.

Cross-Cultural Connections (CCxN) – DUC 150 Office for International Student Engagement (OISE) – Women's Building 102 Office for Religious, Spiritual and Ethical Life (ORSEL) – DUC 150 Spectrum Office (LGBTQIA+ Support) – DUC 150 The Dialogue Across Difference (DxD) program at WashU prepares students to engage in dialogue across perspectives. Students use dialogue to understand each other and see differences as learning opportunities. DxD offers 1 credit 8-week dialogue courses for undergraduate students and workshops and programs open to all graduate, undergraduate, and professional students. Visit us in DUC 340 or our website to learn more about DxD

Gephardt Institute: Students play an essential role in a vibrant and functioning democracy. State and local elections take place throughout the year and have a direct impact on our communities. Visit vote411.org to find dates and details of upcoming elections in every state. You can register to vote, request an absentee ballot, confirm your polling location, and get Election Day reminders at <http://wustl.turbovote.org> for any of the 50 states and Washington D.C. WashU students are considered Missouri residents, and eligible student voters can register to vote in the state of

Missouri or their home state. You need to update your voter registration every time you move, even within the same city.

Whether or not you're eligible to vote, you can participate by encouraging your friends to register and vote, engaging your peers in local issues, and taking part in other civic and community engagement activities. For more resources on voting and other civic and community engagement opportunities, including Civic Action Week, please visit <http://washuvotes.washu.edu> and <http://gephardtinstitute.washu.edu>.

University Libraries: WashU Libraries include seven unique locations across the Danforth Campus, but they are much more than just beautiful, quiet spaces for studying and group work. The Libraries include librarians for every discipline on campus, with the expertise to work with you to develop research ideas and find the best resources to meet your needs; you are also encouraged to explore our research guides, tailored for each subject and available online. The Libraries hold over five million items in the collections—print books, journals, electronic resources, databases, and millions more accessible through interlibrary loan—and you can find it all at the search on our home page. Additional resources for students include special collections, data services, citation help, digital publishing, and more. Visit the Libraries website for more details about these and other ways that the Libraries are here to support your academic success.